



Manager User Manual

South African HR and Payroll Platform

Guide to managing your team through NovaHR

Manager Role

Table of Contents

Getting Started

1	What the Manager role can do	3
2	Logging in	3

Your Dashboard

3	Understanding the manager dashboard	4
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Managing Your Team

4	Viewing your direct reports	5
5	Viewing a team member's profile	6

Leave Approvals

6	Reviewing team leave requests	7
7	Approving or rejecting a request	8
8	Your own leave requests	8

Reports

9	Team reports	9
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1. What the Manager role can do

Manager

Your role in NovaHR

As a manager you see your own full profile and the profiles of your direct reports. You can approve or reject leave requests from your team, view basic payroll cost summaries, and access workforce reports. You cannot see salaries, banking details, payslips, or PAYE details of people outside your team.

What you can do

- View and manage your own profile and leave
- See full profiles of all your direct reports
- Approve or reject leave requests from your team
- View team payroll cost (gross total, no individual salaries)
- Submit leave on behalf of a team member
- Access workforce and leave reports

Restrictions to be aware of

- You cannot approve your own leave requests
- You cannot see salaries of employees outside your team
- You cannot access Payroll runs, Compliance, or Settings
- You cannot see banking details of any employee
- Changes to job titles or salaries must go through HR

2. Logging in

- 1 **Go to novahr-five.vercel.app.** You will see the login page if you are not already signed in.
- 2 **Enter your email and password** (the ones you set when you accepted your invitation from HR).
- 3 **Click Sign in.** You are taken directly to your manager dashboard.



Forgot your password? Click *Forgot password* on the login page. A reset email will be sent to the address HR registered for you.

3. Understanding the manager dashboard

Your team at a glance the moment you sign in

The screenshot shows a NovaHR dashboard for a user named Thabo Nkosi, Manager. The dashboard includes a sidebar with links to Dashboard, My Team, and Leave. The main content area displays a greeting, a summary of team status (3 team members, 1 on leave), pending approvals (1 request), team payroll (R198.3K), and team members on leave (1 member). It also features a 'My team' section with a list of direct reports (Aisha Patel, Johan Pretorius, Naledi Mahlangu) and a 'Leave approvals' section with a pending request from Johan Pretorius. Numbered callouts (1-7) point to the sidebar, team headcount, pending approvals, payroll, leave today, direct reports list, and leave approval queue respectively.

- 1 Sidebar: Dashboard, My Team, Leave (your three sections)
- 2 My team headcount and who is on leave today
- 3 Pending approvals: leave requests awaiting your review
- 4 Team payroll gross total for this month
- 5 Team members on leave today
- 6 Your direct reports list with status and a link to view the full team
- 7 Leave approval queue: pending requests with quick approve and reject buttons

💡 The **Leave approvals** card on the right side of your dashboard shows any pending leave requests from your team. You can approve or reject them directly from the dashboard without navigating to the Leave page.

4. Viewing your direct reports

The employee directory filtered to your team

Dashboard

My Team

Leave

My Team

View your direct reports' profiles and onboarding progress.

4
Total employees

3
Active

0
Onboarding

8
Departments

Search by name, role or email...

All department

All statuses

Employee	Department	Status	Type	Location	Annual salary	Onboarding
Aisha Patel Senior Software Engineer	Engineering	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 950.0K	-
Johan Pretorius Software Engineer	Engineering	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 650.0K	-
Naledi Mahlangu DevOps Engineer	Engineering	On leave	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 780.0K	-
Thabo Nkosi VP of Engineering	Engineering	Active	Full-time	Cape Town, HQ	R 1.6M	-

Thabo Nkosi
Manager

- 1

Search your team by name, role, or email
- 2

Filter by status (Active, On leave, Onboarding)
- 3

Click any row to open that team member's full profile
- 4

Onboarding progress for new starters in your team

Go to **My Team** in the sidebar. You will see:

- **Your direct reports:** all employees who have you assigned as their manager
- **Employee status badges:** Active (green), On leave (blue), Onboarding (orange)
- **Annual salary for your reports** (visible because they are in your scope)
- **Department, job title, and location** for each person

If an employee who reports to you does not appear in your team view, ask your HR administrator to verify that the employee's reporting manager is set to your name on their profile.

5. Viewing a team member's profile

Click any employee row in My Team to open their full profile. As a manager you can see:

Profile section	Manager can see	Manager can edit
Personal info	Name, email, phone, address	No
Job info	Title, department, start date, employment type	No
Compensation	Annual gross salary, allowances	No (HR only)

Leave balances	Yes (all leave types)	No (auto-managed)
Onboarding checklist	Yes	No
Banking details	No	No
Payslips	No	No
Tax/PAYE details	No	No



If you notice that a team member's salary, job title, or manager needs updating, contact your HR administrator. These fields can only be changed by HR.

6. Reviewing team leave requests

Leave

Review your team's leave requests and balances.

1 Pending requests: 1 (Awaiting review)

0 On leave today: 0 (Out of 4 employees)

2 Approved this period: 2 (7 days total)

0 Declined this period: 0 (Requests rejected)

2 Filter and tab navigation: Requests, Balances, Policies, Public holidays

3 Leave request list filtered to your team: employee, type, dates, working days

4 Quick approve (green tick) and reject (red X) buttons

Employee	Type	Dates	Days	Reason	Doc	Status	Actions
Aisha Patel Engineering	Sick leave	10 Jun 2026 to 11 Jun 2026	2	Flu, doctor's note attached.		Approved	Thabo Nkosi
Johan Pretorius Engineering	Family responsibility leave	15 Jun 2026 to 15 Jun 2026	1	School orientation day for my d...		Pending	✓ ✗
Naledi Mahlangu Engineering	Annual leave	09 Jun 2026 to 13 Jun 2026	5	Family vacation to Mauritius, bo...		Approved	Lerato Dlamini

1 Request leave button: submit leave on behalf of a team member

2 Filter and tab navigation: Requests, Balances, Policies

3 Leave request list filtered to your team: employee, type, dates, working days

4 Quick approve (green tick) and reject (red X) buttons

Go to **Leave** in the sidebar. You only see leave requests from your direct reports (not the whole company). Requests are sorted with pending ones at the top.

What to check before approving

- Is there enough leave balance remaining?
- Will business operations be affected?
- Are there other team members already on leave at the same time?
- Has the employee provided a reason (required for all types)?
- For sick leave over 2 days: is a medical certificate attached?

Leave type quick guide

- **Annual:** pre-planned; requires reasonable notice
- **Sick:** unexpected; may require medical certificate
- **Family:** for immediate family events; 3 days/year
- **Maternity/parental:** refer to HR
- **Study:** exams or study; 5 days/year

7. Approving or rejecting a request

- 1** Find the **pending request** in the Leave page or on your dashboard's Leave approvals card. Pending requests have an orange badge.

- 2 **To approve:** click the green tick ✓ button on the right side of the request row. The decision is saved immediately, the employee's balance is decremented, and the employee receives an email notification.
- 3 **To reject:** click the red X button. A text field appears asking for a rejection reason. Enter a brief explanation (for example "Team is fully staffed this week; please re-request for the following week") and click Reject. The employee is notified of the rejection and the reason you provided.



You **cannot approve or reject your own leave requests**. Your leave requests go directly to HR for approval. This is a system rule to prevent conflicts of interest.



Once approved, the leave request status changes to **Approved** (green badge) and the employee's balance is automatically updated. You cannot undo an approval; if a change is needed, ask HR to adjust the balance manually.

8. Your own leave requests

Submitting leave as a manager works the same as for employees

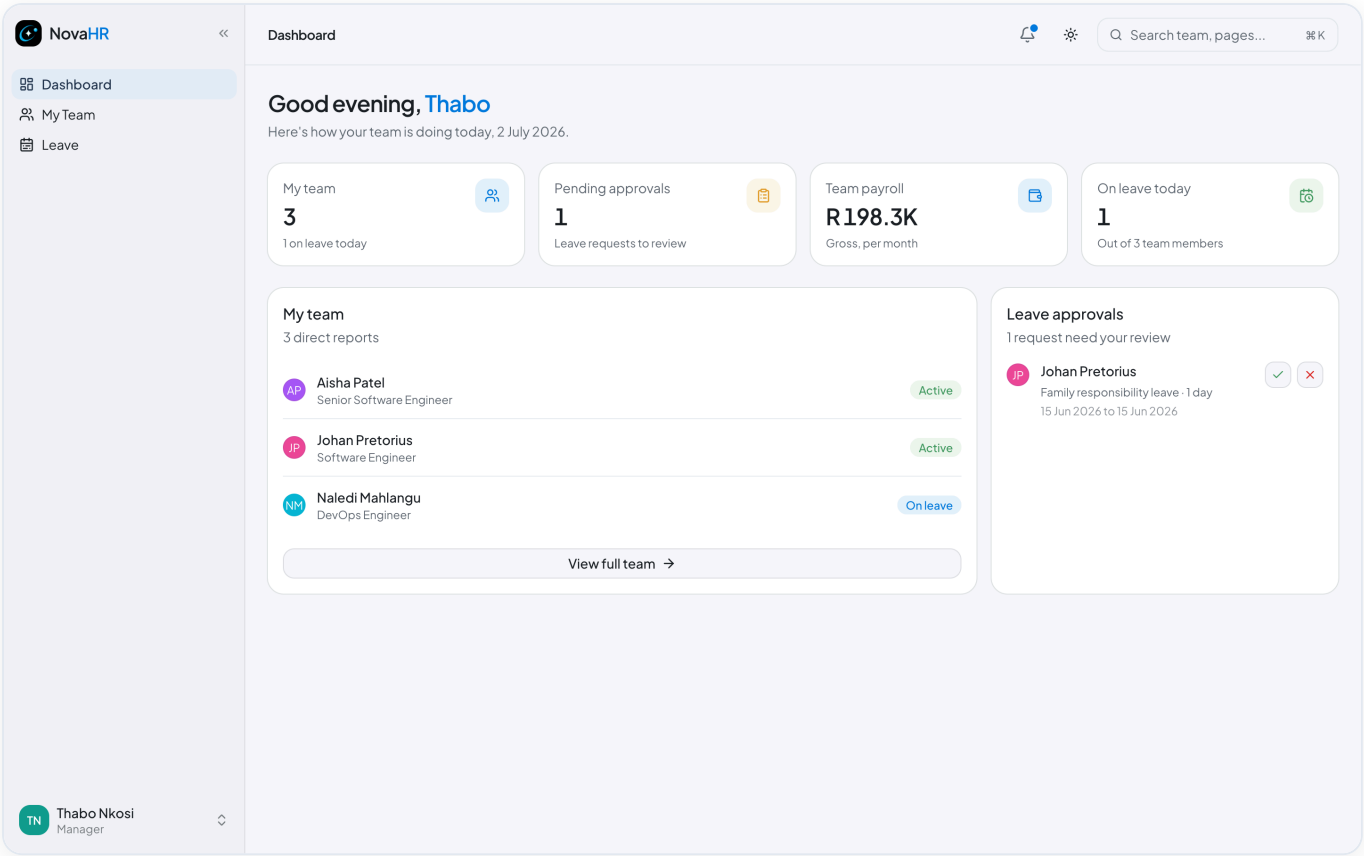
- 1 **Click Request leave** at the top of the Leave page. You are submitting leave for yourself.
- 2 **Select the leave type, dates, and add a reason.** The working-day count is calculated automatically.
- 3 **Submit the request.** It goes to your HR administrator for approval. Your manager (if you have one set) may also be notified.



Try to submit leave requests as early as possible, especially for annual leave, so HR can plan coverage for your team while you are away.

9. Team reports

Analytics for your team and the broader organisation



Go to **Reports** in the sidebar to access workforce and leave analytics.

Workforce report

- Headcount trend over time
- Employment type mix
- Department breakdown across the company

Leave report

- Approved leave days by type (company-wide)
- Leave usage trend chart

As a manager you see company-wide workforce and leave data in reports. Individual salary figures and payroll run details are not visible; only HR and executives with full access can see that information.

Quick Reference: Manager Tasks

Task	Where to go
See who is on leave today	Dashboard stat card at the top
Approve a pending leave request	Dashboard > Leave approvals card, or Leave > Requests tab
Reject a leave request with a reason	Leave > Requests tab > click the red X button
View a team member's leave balance	My Team > click the employee > Leave tab on their profile
Submit your own leave	Leave > Request leave

Leave approval best practices

- ✓ Aim to respond to leave requests within 1 business day
- ✓ Check the leave balance before approving to avoid negative balances
- ✓ Always provide a clear reason when rejecting, and suggest an alternative date if possible
- ✓ For medical certificates, check that a document is attached to sick leave requests before approving
- ✓ If you are unsure about a leave type (for example maternity or commissioning parental leave), escalate to HR
- ✓ Submit your own leave requests early to give HR adequate time to plan coverage

Getting help

Speak to your HR administrator for anything involving salary changes, terminations, new employee additions, or leave balance corrections. For technical issues with the platform, email: **mtshwenewesley@gmail.com**